

NUR 1060 Gerontology

COURSE INSTRUCTOR

Instructor: Karen Bribiesca, MSN, RN, Dr. Dinah Herrick, MSN-Ed, RN

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Office Hours: Refer to Course Announcements for hours.

PROGRAM LEARNING OUTCOMES

PLO1. Implement evidence-based nursing interventions as appropriate for managing the care of patients and promoting health across the lifespan.

PLO2. Provide a patient-centered, evidence-based practice using developmentally and culturally appropriate approaches.

PLO3. Demonstrate effective critical thinking and decision-making skills to advance nursing practice and quality outcomes.

PLO4. Apply leadership principles and quality improvement to promote health policy and patient advocacy.

PLO5. Integrate the professional standards of moral, ethical, and legal concepts into nursing practice.

PLO6. Value the inherent worth of individuals and populations through self-evaluation, service, social justice, and lifelong learning.

COURSE DESCRIPTION

This course will provide the student with the foundation for nursing practice with the older adult client. The physical and psychosocial changes associated with aging will be examined including adaptive behaviors in the normal aging person. Health and socialization, financial considerations, legal considerations of the aging client, cultural needs, and interaction with the healthcare system will be reviewed. The need for multidisciplinary interaction with the aging client will be discussed. Common concerns of an aging population will be covered within the course.

COURSE LEARNING OUTCOMES

1. Identify key areas of educational guidelines for older adults and families related to pharmacological and nonpharmacological approaches for the treatment of the most common neurodegenerative, respiratory, cardiovascular, endocrine, musculoskeletal, and integumentary disorders in later life.
2. Explain pharmacological and nonpharmacological pain management therapies.
3. Discuss an interprofessional and evidence-based plan of care that supports safe medication practices, maintains a healthy nutritional status, adopts preventive measures for skin health, encourages physical activity, and promotes safety in adults at risk for falls.
4. Compare and contrast the major psychosocial theories of aging.
5. Compare the three levels of prevention in promoting health and preventing illness in later life.
6. Compare health care services available for older adults in the United States.
7. Differentiate between abuse and neglect and explain the nurse's role in the prevention of mistreatment of older adults.
8. Apply technology and information management tools to discuss physical assessment findings and laboratory test results of older adults that differ in meaning from younger adults.

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COURSE HOURS AND CREDITS

Quarter credit hours: 2.5

Instructional hours: 25

For complete credit hour policy, please see the [University Catalog](#).

COURSE DATES AND CLASS HOURS

Course start date: July 21, 2025

Course end date: September 28, 2025

Class hours: Refer to the schedule on Edverum.

This course is offered in a blended learning format. Instruction takes place on-ground and online asynchronous using Edverum, a learning management system. Online asynchronous instructional weeks begin on Monday and end on Sunday at 11:59 PM PST.

ATTENDANCE POLICY FOR ONLINE COURSES

Students participating in the university's asynchronous online courses are expected to be in attendance in accordance with the syllabus as participation is essential to student learning and the assessment of the achievement of required outcomes. Blended learning courses may require a set number of academically related activities (ARAs) for each online instructional week. ARAs designated as attendance ARAs are clarified in the course outline.

A student's failure to participate in the designated attendance ARA, such as contributing substantively to a discussion forum post, will result in an absence. A student is in continuous attendance as long as there are no more than fourteen (14) calendar days between attendance ARAs.

For complete attendance policies, please see the [University Catalog](#) for institutional and program-specific policies.

REQUIRED TEXTBOOK(S)

Touhy, T. A., & Jett, K. F. (2023). *Toward healthy aging: Human needs & nursing response* (11th ed.). Elsevier.
<https://online.vitalsource.com/reader/books/9780323554220/pageid/0>

COURSE POLICY AND REQUIREMENTS

Regular substantive interaction is a requirement so that instructors can maintain contact with students on a regular and timely basis and thereby ensure the quality of their instruction and the level of participation and performance of their students. Students are expected to interact in meaningful ways with their instructors and with each other to achieve the highest level of learning.

Students are expected to participate in a variety of learning activities including reading, discussion forums, quizzes, tests, and written and oral assignments.

GRADING AND COURSE EVALUATION METHODS

ASSIGNMENTS AND ASSESSMENTS	Week	Points	Total Points
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Discussion Board	1-10	20	200
Exam	4, 7, 10	50	150
Interview, Plan of Care, and Educational Material	6	100	100
Nursing Case Study	8	50	50
TOTAL POINTS			500

Students who have a running score of below 77% are required to meet their instructor prior to the next scheduled assessment.

THEORY LATE WORK POLICY

Completing work in a timely manner is an important part of your responsibility as a student. Due dates for every assignment are provided on the course syllabus. If you have any questions about an assignment, its requirements, or due date, please immediately ask the course's faculty or program administration.

Assignments that are not submitted by the due date are considered late. Every assignment due date is a hard deadline, and a grace period is not provided. Technical issues do not extend an assignment's due date. Any technical issues should be reported to the course's faculty as well as edverum-support@stanbridge.edu.

The following policy applies to late work for all nursing courses unless otherwise stated in the course syllabus:

1. An assignment submitted up to 24 hours late will be subject to a 25% penalty.
2. An assignment submitted up to 48 hours late will be subject to a 50% penalty.
3. An assignment submitted up to 72 hours late will be subject to a 75% penalty.
4. An assignment submitted more than 72 hours late will receive zero points.
5. All assignments must be submitted even if they earn zero credit.
6. Assignments will not be accepted after the last day of the course.

All course and attendance requirements must be completed and a grade of 77% (C+) or better must be achieved to pass the course.

Grade	Meaning	Grade-Point Value
A+	97 - 100%	4.0
A	93 - 96%	4.0
A-	90 – 92%	3.7
B+	87 – 89%	3.3
B	83 – 86%	3.0
B-	80 – 82%	2.7
C+	77 – 79%	2.3
C	75 – 76%	2.0
C-	70 – 74%	1.7
D+	67 – 69%	1.3
D	65 – 66%	1.0

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D-	60 – 64%	0.7
F	59% and below	0
PASS	Satisfactory performance	4.0
FAIL	Unsatisfactory performance	0.00
In Progress	Course not completed	0
TR	Received transfer credit for coursework	Not computed in GPA

For complete grading policies, please see the [University Catalog](#) for institutional and program-specific grading policy.

COURSE OUTLINE

The course discussion forums are the designated attendance ARA for this course. One primary response and two secondary responses must be made in each discussion forum to meet attendance requirements for the week. Carefully review the discussion forum due dates and guidelines.

- **Assessments**

- Review and adhere to the program's Dress Code in the catalog.
- Bring your student ID. You may not take the assessment without your student ID.
- Be on time. You will not be allowed to take the assessment after it has started.
- Observe testing guidelines.

- **Discussion Board in Edverum**

- Review the guidelines, grading rubric, and due dates.

- **Syllabus Acknowledgment**

- Go to *About This Course* and click on *Course Syllabus*.
- Review the syllabus.
- Place a check mark in the box under *Syllabus Acknowledgment* and click *Submit*.

- **Interview, Plan of Care, and Educational Material & Nursing Case Study**

- Review the grading rubric.
- Follow the instructions for submitting the assignment to Turnitin.

Week	Objectives	Lesson	Assignments and Assessments
1	1. Outline the role of gerontological nursing in research related to aging. 2. Define long-term care and long-term care system.	Syllabus Review <u>Chapters</u>	Note: Unless indicated otherwise, assignments are due Sunday, 11:59 PM PST.

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	3. Discuss interventions to improve the care of older adults in skilled nursing facilities, including quality improvement, culture change, and transitional care. 4. Discuss the multidimensional nature of wellness and its implications for healthy aging. 5. Discuss theory-based strategies to foster the highest level of wellness while aging. 6. Compare and contrast the major psychosocial theories of aging. 7. Explain the history of Social Security and Supplementary Security Income and how health care is financed in the United States.	1: Gerontological Nursing Across the Continuum of Care 2: Aging, Health, and Wellness in a Global Community 3: Theories of Aging 5: Economics and Health Care in Late Life	<u>Assignments</u> 1. Syllabus Acknowledgment in Edverum (mandatory and due Sunday, 11:59 PM PST of week 1) 2. Discussion Board
2	1. Identify strategies to move toward cultural proficiency in the delivery of cross-cultural care. 2. Identify gerontological nursing interventions geared toward reducing health disparities. 3. Discuss the importance of communication in the lives of older adults. 4. Identify effective methods to facilitate communication with older adults individually and in groups. 5. Explain cognitive changes with age and strategies to enhance cognitive skills. 6. Identify nursing responses to assist the elderly to maintain or improve cognitive abilities. 7. List the essential components of a comprehensive health assessment of an older adult.	<u>Chapters</u> 4: Providing Cross-Cultural Care 7: Therapeutic Communication with Older Adults 8: Cognitive Health and Learning 9: Recognizing and Analyzing Cues to Maximize Outcomes	<u>Assignment</u> Discussion Board

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	8. Discuss the advantages and disadvantages of standardized assessment instruments.		
3	1. Discuss the key laboratory tests used to monitor health problems in later life. 2. Describe the pharmacokinetic and pharmacodynamic changes that are normal changes with aging and potential problems associated with medication therapy in later life. 3. Identify the early signs of adverse medication reactions and preventative strategies. 4. Identify inappropriate use of medications and explain how it interferes with healthy aging. 5. Outline a nursing plan to promote safe medication practices and prevent medication toxicity. 6. Summarize the information that older adults should know about the use of select dietary supplements. 7. Outline the role of the gerontological nurse when assisting the older adult who uses dietary supplements and a care plan to prevent adverse reactions related to dietary supplement use. 8. Describe diseases of the eye that may occur in older adults and the importance of screening, health education, and treatment of eye diseases to prevent unnecessary vision loss.	<u>Chapters</u> 10: Using Laboratory Data in Clinical Judgment 11: Safe Medication Use 12: Visual Health	<u>Assignment</u> Discussion Board
4	1. Discuss changes in hearing with age and their impact on quality of life and function. 2. Describe the importance of health education and screening for hearing problems and outline effective	<u>Chapters</u> 13: Auditory Health 14: Healthy Skin 15: Nutritional Health 16: Hydration and Oral Health	Exam 1 on campus Content: Weeks 1-3 <u>Assignment</u> Discussion Board

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	communication strategies for individuals with hearing impairment. 3. Identify age-related changes in the integument, risk factors for pressure injuries, and evidence-based interventions for prevention and treatment of impairment to skin integrity. 4. Summarize nutritional requirements and factors affecting nutrition for older adults. 5. Identify risk factors for malnutrition and evidence-based strategies to ensure adequate nutrition. 6. Discuss assessment and interventions for older adults with dysphagia. 7. Discuss interventions or prevention and treatment of dehydration. 8. Discuss common oral problems that can occur with aging and appropriate assessment and interventions.		
5	1. Identify age-related changes and other contributing factors affecting bowel and bladder elimination. 2. Use evidence-based protocols in the assessment and development of interventions to promote bowel and bladder health. 3. Identify age-related changes that affect sleep. 4. Educate individuals, families, and health care staff about sleep disorders and sleep hygiene measures. 5. Describe the relationship between physical activity and health. 6. Discuss ways to incorporate physical activity into daily life. 7. Discuss security and safety measures for older adults and factors that increase vulnerability to falls.	<u>Chapters</u> 17: Elimination 18: Sleep 19: Activity and Exercise 20: Falls and fall Risk Reduction 21: Safe and Secure Environments	<u>Assignment</u> Discussion Board

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	8. Outline a plan of care for older adults at risk of falls and interventions to reduce falls.		
6	1. Identify the most common chronic disorders of late life and nursing interventions that are consistent with the chronic illness trajectory. 2. Identify the most common cardiovascular disorders in later life and interventions to promote healthy aging regardless of the stage of cardiovascular illness. 3. Outline the characteristics of Parkinson's disease. 4. Summarize the key aspects of the evaluation of the person with signs of cognitive limitations. 5. Differentiate the key pharmacological interventions in Parkinson's disease and Alzheimer's disease. 6. Describe the nurse's role in the promotion of healthy aging in persons with neurocognitive disorders. 7. Discuss common conditions that may be related to changes in the aging immune system. 8. Discuss the nurse's role in educating individuals with immune disorders to advance healthy aging.	<u>Chapters</u> 22: Living Well with Chronic Illness 23: Vascular Disorders 25: Neurocognitive Disorders 27: Endocrine and Immune Disorders	<u>Assignments</u> 1. Interview, Plan of Care, and Educational Material 2. Discussion Board
7	1. Identify the most important factors influencing respiratory health. 2. Differentiate the signs and symptoms of osteoarthritis and rheumatoid arthritis in older adults. 3. Summarize the key areas of patient education related to pharmacological and nonpharmacological approaches for the treatment of common musculoskeletal disorders. 4. Define the concept of pain.	<u>Chapters</u> 24: Respiratory Disorders 28: Common Musculoskeletal Disorders 29: Pain and Comfort 30: Mental Health	Exam 2 on campus Content: Weeks 4-6 <u>Assignment</u> Discussion Board

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	5. Discuss pharmacological and nonpharmacological pain management therapies and barriers that interfere with pain assessment and treatment. 6. Discuss the effect of common mental health disorders on individuals as they age. 7. Outline the symptoms of anxiety and depression in older adults and assessment, treatment, and nursing interventions. 8. Recognize older adults who are at risk of suicide and utilize evidence-based techniques for suicide assessment and interventions.		
8	1. Identify the characteristics of delirium and differentiate between delirium, mild and major neurocognitive disorders (NCDs), dementia, and depression disorders. 2. Discuss prevention, treatment, and nursing interventions for individuals with delirium. 3. Differentiate between abuse and neglect. 4. Describe the types of abuse and the nurse's role in the prevention of mistreatment of older adults. 5. Identify the nurse's responsibility for the protection of those with limited mental capacity.	<u>Chapters</u> 26: Care of Individuals with Neurocognitive Disorders 31: Ethics, Decision Making, and Mistreatment	<u>Assignments</u> 1. Nursing Case Study 2. Discussion Board
9	1. Explain the issues involved in adopting to transition and role changes in later life. 2. Discuss the physiological, social, and psychological factors that affect sexual function as people age. 3. Differentiate the different types of grief and the needs of the griever.	<u>Chapters</u> 32: Relationships, Roles, and Life Transitions 33: Intimacy and Sexual Health 34: Loss, Death, and Palliative Care	<u>Assignment</u> Discussion Board

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	4. Discuss nursing attributes that provide the highest quality of care for those experiencing loss or death. 5. Discuss nursing interventions to facilitate spiritual health in older adults.	35: Spiritual Health, Meaning, and Self-Actualization	
10	Examine the impact of the physical and psychosocial issues faced by the geriatric population on your future practice.		Exam 3 on campus Content: Weeks 7-9 <u>Assignment</u> Discussion Board

DISCUSSION BOARD GUIDELINES AND GRADING RUBRIC

Instructional weeks may contain one or two discussion forums. One (1) primary response and two (2) secondary responses are required in each forum. A primary response is a post where you respond to the writing prompt. A secondary response is a post where you respond to a peer's post.

Primary posts must be, at a minimum, 120 words in length, written at a graduate level. Secondary posts do not have a required word count; however, they should be thoroughly written and convey ideas and feedback effectively. Citations from scholarly or peer-reviewed sources must follow APA format.

The primary post is due by Wednesday, 11:59:59 pm PST. Twenty-four hours must elapse between the time of the primary post and the secondary posts. Secondary posts must be completed by Sunday, 11:59:59 pm PST. Points will not be awarded for any posts made after the end of the week.

Discussion Forum Rubric	
Demonstrates	Points Possible
Primary Posting and Content Contribution Posts are well developed and fully address all aspects of the prompt. Content is factually correct, reflective, offers substantive contribution, and advances the discussion. Primary posting must be made by 11:59:59 pm PST on Wednesday of each week.	10
Secondary Posting and Content Contribution Posts demonstrate analysis of peers' posts and extend meaningful discussion by building on course learning and previous posts. Students must respond to at least two peers each week for full credit to be granted. Response posts must be completed by 11:59:59 pm PST on Sunday. Twenty-four hours must elapse between the time of the primary post and two peer responses.	5
Advanced Written Communication Posts use references to literature, readings, or personal experience to support ideas. Posts are clear and concise with content formatted in an easy-to-read style that is free of grammatical or spelling errors.	5
Total Points Possible	20

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ACADEMIC HONESTY

Stanbridge University is committed to academic excellence built on honesty, trust, and respect. All academic community members depend upon the integrity of work that is submitted for academic credit. Any form of cheating, including plagiarism, will not be tolerated.

Please refer to the University Catalog's policy on [Academic Honesty](#) and [Code of Conduct](#).

ELECTRONIC DEVICES POLICY

No recording (audio, video, photo) of class materials is allowed unless written approval is received.

This course may include video and audio recordings of class lectures and classroom activities. These recordings will be used for educational purposes and the instructor will make these available to students currently enrolled in the course. Students must seek instructor permission to share either course recordings or course content/materials. Similarly, instructors who wish to share Zoom recordings with other sections or classes must seek and document permission from students whose image or voice are in these recordings.

STUDENTS WITH DISABILITIES

Students who wish to request disability related accommodations may do so through the [ADA Portal](#) in Student Central or by contacting ADA@stanbridge.edu. More information about the university's [ADA policy](#) can be found in the University Catalog.

STUDENT SUPPORT SERVICES

The university has a wide range of academic support services including faculty and peer tutoring, library, the Excellence in Undergraduate and Graduate Writing Center, online academic skills modules, academic advising, and a Stanbridge Student Assistance Program. For more information about services, please see the [University Catalog](#).